Chapter 2 Summative Assignment: Tire study

A legendary story on college campuses concerns two students who missed an exam because of excessive partying, but they blamed the absence on a flat tire. The professor allowed the students to take a make-up exam in separate rooms. On the exam, the students were asked which tire was flat.

Step 1: Ask a research question

Do students pick which tire went flat in equal proportions? A common conjecture is that students tend to answer "front right" more often than would be expected by chance.

Step 2: Design a study and collect data

To test the conjecture, a professor asked 28 students to imagine being in the same situation as the students in the story and pick one of the four tires. The data is summarized in the table below.

Table 1

Front left	**Front right**	**Rear left**	**Rear right**
6	14	4	4

Exercise 1 What are the observational units?

Exercise 2 What is the variable that is measured and recorded on each observation?

Exercise 3 In words, what is the parameter of interest?

Exercise 4 In words, what are the null and alternative hypothesis?

Step 3: Explore the data

Exercise 5 What proportion of the students picked the right front tire? Is this more than you would expect if students randomly picked one of the four tires?

Exercise 6 Is observing 14 out of 28 picking the front right tire possible if the students are randomly picking between the four tires?

Key Idea 2 3S strategy (Statistic, Simulate, Strength of Evidence). The 3S Strategy will help you investigate how much evidence the sample data provides in support of the research conjecture.

Step 4: Draw inferences

Exercise 7 Statistic: What is the statistic of interest and what is the symbol that is associated with that statistic called?

Now we will use the One proportion simulator at `https://www.rossmanchance.com/applets/2021/oneprop/OneProp.htm?hideExtras=1`

Exercise 8 Simulate: What values for probability of success (π), sample size (n), and number of samples should be entered into the tool to simulate the study?

Exercise 9 Simulate: What is the center of your null distribution? Does the center you observed make sense? Explain.

Exercise 10 Strength of evidence: Using your simulation, what is the p-value? What does the p-value represent?

Exercise 11 Strength of evidence: Using your simulation, what is the standardized statistic? What does this standardized statistic represent?

Exercise 12 Strength of evidence: Using a theory-based z-test (normal approximation), what is the p-value? Are the validity conditions met?

Exercise 13 Strength of evidence: Do all three methods yield strong evidence against the null hypothesis that students pick the front right tire one-fourth of the time in the long run?

Step 5: Formulate conclusions

Exercise 14 What conclusions can you draw from the study?

Exercise 15 What are the wider implications of the study? Do you think the conclusions hold true for people in general?

Step 6: Look back and ahead

Exercise 16 If you were to repeat this study, what improvements would you make? What further research would you propose related to this topic in the future?

Another professor conducted a similar study with a smaller class and found that 7 out of 14 students picked the front right tire.

Exercise 17 Do you expect that this study will yield stronger, weaker, or the same evidence against the null hypothesis? Explain.

Again we will use the One proportion simulator at `https://www.rossmanchance.com/applets/2021/oneprop/OneProp.htm?hideExtras=1`

Exercise 18 Conduct a simulation analysis and produce a p-value. How does this p-value compare to the p-value you calculated for the sample of 28 students?

Suppose you didn't have a preconceived notion that the right front tire would be chosen more often, but instead just wanted to find out if the front right tire was chosen at a rate that was different than one-fourth. Consider the original sample of 28 students.

Exercise 19 In words, what are the null and alternative hypotheses for this new question?

Exercise 20 Conduct a theory-based analysis and produce a p-value. How does this p-value compare to the theory-based p-value you calculated for the sample of 28 students using the original setup?

Exercise 21 Do you have strong evidence against the null hypothesis that students choose the right front tire one-fourth of the time in the long run?